All About

ferns

Have you ever spotted a fern?

Have you ever spotted a green bush that looked sligthly odd, or a weed that didn't look quite right?



Chances are you might have spotted a fern.

Ferns can be commonly mistaken for weeds or shrubs even though they are entirely different.

Fun facts about ferns

Ferns actually make up a special group of plants known as **pteridophytes**.

They are **non-flowering** and **non-seed producing** plants.

Some ferns grow on other plants for supprt e.g trees, making them **epiphytes**.

They exhibit a special type of life cycle called **alternation of generation**.

Alternation of generation in ferns

Alternation of generations means ferns exhibit two distinct stages in one life cycle – the **sporopyte stage**, and the **gametophyte stage**.

In ferns the **dominanant** stage of life is the **sporophyte** stage. This is when spores are released.

The **gametophyte** stage is the **less dominant** phase. This is when fertilization occurs.

NB: Ferns require water for fertilization to take place.



How to differentiate ferns from other green plants

Ferns are non-flowering. If the plant has tiny buds or flowers, it is not a fern.

Ferns have brown or yellowish bumps under their leaves which when grouped together are known as **sori**. The sori holds spores used for reproduction.



Many ferns have highly disected, feathery leaves.

